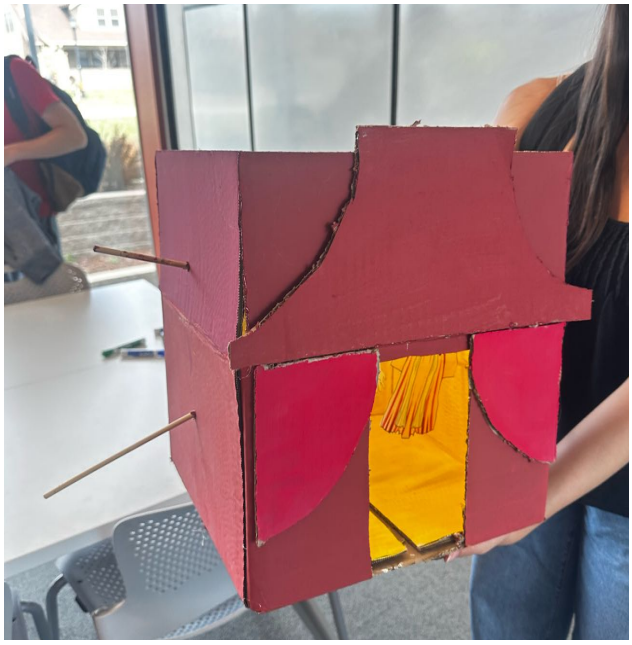
Student Work: Interactive Theater Box inspired by *Farewell My Concubine*



#2 Animals, Plants, and Monsters: Zoo Field Trip and Creative Writing

We will visit the Cheyenne Mountain Zoo to meet the primates. We will spend time in front of the primate exhibit in silence doing free write. Use this time to write about the encounter between you and the animal. I invite you to be porous and let sensations penetrate your body and mind. Note what you see and feel, sense and smell; document movements and stillness, gestures, eyes, hair, shapes, emotions, affects that surface for both you and the animal. There are no rules for this free write—the only requirement is to be fully present with the encounter. We will then have a conversation to share impressions and brainstorm story ideas.

At home, expand your free write into a short story based on the encounter. Incorporate motifs from the stories we have read and watched.

You are free to experiment, but if you need ideas, here are some starting points:

• Imagine the Monkey King from China reincarnated as this primate in a Colorado zoo and escaping on a "Journey to the East."
• Rewrite Monkey King's Havoc in Heaven episode as "Havoc in the White House."
• Imagine a body exchange between you and the monkey—what happens when the monkey spends a day as a CC student?
• Invent your own scenario (highly encouraged!)

As you craft your story, reflect on the role of language, narrative perspective, animal-human dynamic, the zoo as an institution, and/or other themes we have explored so far. Think in terms of deep time and expansive space, and consider how such imagination might reshape the reader's view of what is animal and what is human.

Submissions:
1. Free write: ~300 words, due onsite of field trip
2. Short story (70%): ~1200 words, due field trip day 9 PM
3. Reflection on creation and insight (30%): ~500 words, due next day 9 PM

#3 Intro to Asian Studies: Mapping Asia

Research your assigned maps and prepare a 10-minute presentation. In your presentation, explain who made the map, when and where it was created, and what was happening historically at that time is relevant to the understanding and imagination of the world. How the map imagines or represents the world and what this tells us about how people in that period understood "Asia"? Also point out any interesting or surprising details you found while researching the map.

1. c. 625–700 — Isidore of Seville, *Etymologiae* / *De natura rerum*, T–O world map.
One of the earliest known schematic world maps in the Western tradition, dividing the world into Asia, Europe, and Africa.

2. ca. 1389 — *Da Ming Hunyi Tu* 大明混一圖 (Amalgamated Map of the Great Ming).
A major early Ming world map integrating Chinese, Mongol/Yuan, Islamic, and possibly Korean geographic knowledge.